

SAT Vocabulary Master

100 Essential Words • 4 Difficulty Tiers

Sentence Completion • Words in Context • Matching Exercises

Tier 1 — Foundation	Words 1–25 Core academic vocabulary
Tier 2 — Intermediate	Words 26–50 Regular SAT-level challenge
Tier 3 — Advanced	Words 51–75 Upper-score differentiators
Tier 4 — Expert	Words 76–100 Highest-difficulty vocabulary

Complete Answer Key with Explanations • Student-Friendly Format • SAT Test Prep

How to Use This Book

This workbook contains **100 SAT vocabulary words** organized into four progressive difficulty tiers. Each section provides three types of exercises to build both recognition and contextual understanding — the two skills tested on the SAT.

1. Sentence Completion

Each question presents a sentence with a blank. Choose the word (A–D) that best completes the meaning of the sentence. Read the entire sentence before choosing — look for contrast words (however, yet, although) and support words (likewise, therefore, as a result) that signal whether the blank needs a word with a similar or opposite meaning to other context clues.

2. Words in Context

A short academic passage is followed by two questions asking what a specific word means as it is used in that passage. The correct answer fits the passage's meaning — not just a dictionary definition. Reread the sentence containing the word and substitute each answer choice to test which one preserves the meaning best.

3. Matching Exercise

Ten words from the section are listed on the left. Ten definitions are listed on the right in scrambled order. Write the letter of the matching definition next to each word. This exercise builds rapid-recall vocabulary knowledge — an essential SAT skill.

Study Tips

- Work through one section per study session, spending 30–45 minutes.
- Complete the exercises before checking the Answer Key at the back.
- For each wrong answer, read the explanation carefully and write a new sentence using the word.
- Use the Vocabulary Reference Table at the start of each section as a study guide.
- Return to difficult words three days later for spaced-repetition review.

Vocabulary Reference

Study these definitions before attempting the exercises.

Word	Part of Speech	Definition
pragmatic	<i>adj.</i>	Dealing with things sensibly and realistically rather than ideally.
ambiguous	<i>adj.</i>	Open to more than one interpretation; not clear or decided.
concise	<i>adj.</i>	Giving a lot of information clearly and in few words.
meticulous	<i>adj.</i>	Showing great attention to detail; very careful and precise.
prodigal	<i>adj.</i>	Spending money or resources freely and recklessly; wastefully extravagant.
eloquent	<i>adj.</i>	Fluent or persuasive in speaking or writing; movingly expressive.
candid	<i>adj.</i>	Truthful and straightforward; frank and open.
benevolent	<i>adj.</i>	Well meaning and kindly; generous toward others.
diligent	<i>adj.</i>	Having or showing care and conscientiousness in one's work or duties.
mundane	<i>adj.</i>	Lacking interest or excitement; dull; of this earthly world rather than a spiritual one.
versatile	<i>adj.</i>	Able to adapt or be adapted to many different functions or activities.
tenacious	<i>adj.</i>	Holding firmly to a purpose, goal, or opinion; not readily letting go; persistent.
vivid	<i>adj.</i>	Producing powerful feelings or clear, striking images in the mind.
skeptical	<i>adj.</i>	Not easily convinced; having doubts or reservations about something.
lucid	<i>adj.</i>	Expressed clearly and easy to understand; mentally clear and rational.
divert	<i>v.</i>	To cause to change course or redirect; to distract someone from something.
mitigate	<i>v.</i>	To make less severe, serious, or painful; to lessen the impact of.
scrutinize	<i>v.</i>	To examine or inspect closely and thoroughly.
enhance	<i>v.</i>	To intensify, increase, or further improve the quality, value, or extent of.

Word	Part of Speech	Definition
consolidate	<i>v.</i>	To make something stronger or more solid; to combine into a single more effective whole.
depict	<i>v.</i>	To represent by a drawing, painting, or other art form; to portray in words.
advocate	<i>v./n.</i>	To publicly recommend or support; a person who supports a particular cause or policy.
critique	<i>v./n.</i>	To evaluate in a detailed and analytical way; a detailed analysis and assessment.
endeavor	<i>v./n.</i>	To try hard to do or achieve something; an attempt to achieve a goal.
disparity	<i>n.</i>	A great difference; a lack of equality or similarity between groups or things.

Part A — Sentence Completion

Directions: Choose the word (A–D) that best completes the sentence.

1. Rather than proposing an idealistic plan that could never be funded, the committee chair took a _____ approach and suggested modest, achievable reforms.
 - (A) sentimental
 - (B) pragmatic
 - (C) flamboyant
 - (D) pedantic
2. The contract's wording was so _____ that both parties believed it supported their conflicting positions.
 - (A) definitive
 - (B) transparent
 - (C) ambiguous
 - (D) lucid
3. A good executive summary should be _____: it must convey all critical information in no more than one page.
 - (A) verbose
 - (B) convoluted
 - (C) concise
 - (D) elaborate

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4. The forensic accountant was _____ in her review, examining every receipt, invoice, and transaction log for even the smallest discrepancy.
- (A) haphazard
 - (B) meticulous
 - (C) cursory
 - (D) negligent
5. His _____ spending habits left him bankrupt within two years of inheriting a substantial fortune.
- (A) frugal
 - (B) prudent
 - (C) prodigal
 - (D) meager
6. The attorney's closing argument was so _____ that several jurors were visibly moved and the judge praised its clarity.
- (A) rambling
 - (B) eloquent
 - (C) terse
 - (D) incoherent
7. Surprisingly _____ for a politician, she admitted that her previous policy position had been wrong and outlined how she planned to change it.
- (A) evasive
 - (B) candid
 - (C) guarded
 - (D) circumspect
8. The _____ donor wished to remain anonymous; he simply wanted to ensure that every child in the district had access to school supplies.
- (A) miserly
 - (B) malevolent
 - (C) benevolent
 - (D) indifferent
9. Only the most _____ students consistently complete every reading assignment, attend every study session, and review their notes that same day.
- (A) indolent
 - (B) diligent
 - (C) capricious
 - (D) lethargic

10. After years of high-stakes diplomatic work, she found answering routine emails unexpectedly _____.

- (A) thrilling
- (B) complex
- (C) mundane
- (D) enriching

11. The software proved remarkably _____: it was used equally by architects designing skyscrapers and students mapping family trees.

- (A) rigid
- (B) versatile
- (C) specialized
- (D) obsolete

12. Despite three rejections from publishers, the _____ novelist revised her manuscript and submitted it a fourth time — and was finally offered a contract.

- (A) resigned
- (B) tenacious
- (C) fickle
- (D) indifferent

13. Her _____ description of the rainforest — the cacophony of insects, the thick humid air, the blinding green light — made readers feel they were there.

- (A) vague
- (B) tepid
- (C) abstract
- (D) vivid

14. The journalist remained _____ of the company's optimistic press release, insisting on seeing the raw data before writing her story.

- (A) credulous
- (B) trustful
- (C) skeptical
- (D) compliant

15. The professor's _____ explanation of quantum entanglement made the concept accessible even to students with no physics background.

- (A) muddled
- (B) convoluted
- (C) lucid
- (D) abstruse

16. The magician uses elaborate hand gestures to _____ the audience's attention while secretly palming the card.

- (A) focus
- (B) divert
- (C) concentrate
- (D) intensify

17. Installing flood barriers will not eliminate the risk entirely, but it will significantly _____ the damage caused by storm surges.

- (A) exacerbate
- (B) amplify
- (C) mitigate
- (D) accelerate

18. Safety inspectors _____ every weld joint in the bridge structure before clearing it for public use.

- (A) overlook
- (B) scrutinize
- (C) ignore
- (D) estimate

19. Adding a dash of lemon zest will _____ the flavor of the sauce, bringing out the subtler herbal notes.

- (A) diminish
- (B) neutralize
- (C) enhance
- (D) suppress

20. The merger was designed to _____ three regional offices into a single national headquarters, reducing overhead and improving coordination.

- (A) fragment
- (B) scatter
- (C) consolidate
- (D) diversify

21. The mural was commissioned to _____ the town's history from its founding as a fishing village to its current role as a technology hub.

- (A) ignore
- (B) conceal
- (C) depict
- (D) contradict

22. The pediatrician used every public platform available to _____ for stricter regulations on sugar content in children's beverages.

- (A) oppose
- (B) advocate
- (C) dismiss
- (D) neglect

23. The writing workshop requires each participant to _____ two peers' essays, offering specific suggestions for improvement.

- (A) plagiarize
- (B) ignore
- (C) critique
- (D) transcribe

24. Despite limited resources, the research team would _____ to publish their findings before the end of the fiscal year.

- (A) decline
- (B) endeavor
- (C) neglect
- (D) abandon

25. The report documented a troubling _____ in graduation rates between students from wealthy districts and those from low-income areas.

- (A) similarity
- (B) disparity
- (C) uniformity
- (D) harmony

Part B — Words in Context

Directions: Read each passage, then answer the questions that follow.

Passage 1 — The Professor's Paradox

Professor Aldridge was known for two apparently contradictory qualities. Her lecture notes were brutally concise — bullet points, no wasted words — yet when she spoke, she was among the most eloquent voices in the department. Former students recalled that she could illuminate a theorem in three sentences on paper and then spend an inspired twenty minutes unpacking those same three sentences aloud, drawing connections that left the room in stunned silence.

WIC-1. As used in the passage, 'concise' most nearly means:

- (A) incomplete and rushed
- (B) brief yet information-dense
- (C) overly simplified
- (D) hastily written

WIC-2. The word 'eloquent' as used in the passage primarily suggests that Professor Aldridge:

- (A) spoke loudly and confidently
- (B) relied on technical vocabulary
- (C) expressed ideas with grace and persuasive power
- (D) spoke at excessive length

Passage 2 — Optimism and Evidence

Two scientists reviewed identical data from the clinical trial. Dr. Okafor was sanguine about the results, believing they pointed toward a breakthrough treatment. Dr. Levi was skeptical, noting that the sample size was small and that two of the most promising results came from patients who had also changed their diet during the trial. Their disagreement was not a failure of science but its engine: progress requires both the optimist who sees possibility and the doubter who demands proof.

WIC-3. In context, 'sanguine' most nearly means:

- (A) cautious and methodical
- (B) confidently optimistic
- (C) recklessly enthusiastic
- (D) professionally detached

WIC-4. The passage suggests Dr. Levi's 'skeptical' response was:

- (A) an obstacle to scientific progress
- (B) a sign of inadequate preparation
- (C) a valuable check on premature conclusions
- (D) motivated by personal rivalry

Part C — Matching

Directions: Write the letter of the matching definition (A–J) next to each word.

1. pragmatic	_____ ____	A. Clear and easy to understand
2. ambiguous	_____ ____	B. Fluent and persuasive in speech or writing
3. meticulous	_____ ____	C. Wastefully extravagant with money or resources
4. prodigal	_____ ____	D. Not easily convinced; having doubts
5. eloquent	_____ ____	E. Truthful and straightforward; frank
6. candid	_____ ____	F. Sensible and realistic; practical
7. diligent	_____ ____	G. Showing great care and attention to detail
8. tenacious	_____ ____	H. Conscientious and careful in one's work
9. skeptical	_____ ____	I. Open to more than one interpretation
10. lucid	_____ ____	J. Holding firmly to a purpose; persistent

Vocabulary Reference

Study these definitions before attempting the exercises.

Word	Part of Speech	Definition
recalcitrant	<i>adj.</i>	Having an obstinately uncooperative attitude toward authority or discipline.
disparate	<i>adj.</i>	Essentially different in kind; not allowing comparison; made up of very different elements.
evanescent	<i>adj.</i>	Soon passing out of sight, memory, or existence; quickly fading or disappearing.
sanguine	<i>adj.</i>	Optimistic or positive, especially in a difficult situation.
pedantic	<i>adj.</i>	Excessively concerned with minor details or rules; overly academic in approach.
equivocal	<i>adj.</i>	Open to more than one interpretation; deliberately ambiguous or unclear.
loquacious	<i>adj.</i>	Tending to talk a great deal; excessively talkative.
austere	<i>adj.</i>	Severe or strict in manner or attitude; having no comforts or luxuries; plain.
venerate	<i>v.</i>	To regard with great respect and reverence.
placate	<i>v.</i>	To make someone less angry or hostile; to appease or pacify.
exacerbate	<i>v.</i>	To make a problem, bad situation, or negative feeling worse.
precipitate	<i>v.</i>	To cause an event or situation to happen suddenly, unexpectedly, or prematurely.
enumerate	<i>v.</i>	To mention a number of things one by one; to establish the number of.
ameliorate	<i>v.</i>	To make something bad or unsatisfactory better; to improve.
corroborate	<i>v.</i>	To confirm or give support to a statement, theory, or finding.
ostensible	<i>adj.</i>	Appearing or stated to be true, but not necessarily so; outwardly appearing as such.
ephemeral	<i>adj.</i>	Lasting for a very short time; transitory.

Word	Part of Speech	Definition
pragmatism	<i>n.</i>	An approach that evaluates theories or beliefs in terms of their practical application.
acrimony	<i>n.</i>	Bitterness or ill feeling, especially in speech or manner; sharp hostility.
credulous	<i>adj.</i>	Having too great a readiness to believe things without sufficient evidence; gullible.
fortuitous	<i>adj.</i>	Happening by a lucky chance rather than by intention; fortunate.
laconic	<i>adj.</i>	Using very few words; brief and concise in speech or expression.
diffident	<i>adj.</i>	Modest or shy because of a lack of self-confidence.
poignant	<i>adj.</i>	Evoking a keen sense of sadness or regret; deeply moving; touching.
voluble	<i>adj.</i>	Talking fluently, readily, or incessantly; talkative.

Part A — Sentence Completion

Directions: Choose the word (A–D) that best completes the sentence.

26. Even after three warnings from the principal, the _____ student refused to remove his headphones during the exam.

- (A) compliant
- (B) obedient
- (C) recalcitrant
- (D) amenable

27. The team was composed of _____ professionals — a neuroscientist, a jazz musician, a retired general, and a chef — yet they produced a cohesive plan.

- (A) homogeneous
- (B) uniform
- (C) disparate
- (D) similar

28. Morning fog is inherently _____: it burns off within hours of sunrise, leaving no trace of its brief dominance.

- (A) permanent
- (B) evanescent
- (C) enduring
- (D) persistent

29. Despite the poor early sales figures, the CEO remained _____ about the product's long-term prospects, citing favorable demographic trends.

- (A) pessimistic
- (B) despondent
- (C) sanguine
- (D) resigned

30. His _____ insistence on correcting every grammatical slip in casual conversation made him difficult to talk to at parties.

- (A) casual
- (B) flexible
- (C) pedantic
- (D) relaxed

31. The spokesperson's _____ answer — 'We are committed to best practices' — satisfied no one, since it could mean almost anything.

- (A) direct
- (B) definitive
- (C) equivocal
- (D) forthright

32. The _____ tour guide spoke continuously for three hours, barely pausing for breath even when tourists clearly wanted to take photos.

- (A) taciturn
- (B) reticent
- (C) loquacious
- (D) laconic

33. The monk's cell was _____: a straw mattress, a wooden stool, and a single candle constituted all his possessions.

- (A) lavish
- (B) opulent
- (C) austere
- (D) ornate

34. In many cultures, elders are _____ for their wisdom and life experience, and their counsel is sought before major decisions.

- (A) belittled
- (B) venerated
- (C) ridiculed
- (D) dismissed

35. Management offered the striking workers a modest raise in an attempt to _____ them, though the union deemed it insufficient.

- (A) antagonize
- (B) provoke
- (C) placate
- (D) agitate

36. Cutting funding to mental health services during an economic downturn would only _____ an already critical shortage of resources.

- (A) alleviate
- (B) exacerbate
- (C) mitigate
- (D) ameliorate

37. The leaked memo threatened to _____ a full-scale crisis just days before the annual shareholder meeting.

- (A) prevent
- (B) delay
- (C) precipitate
- (D) resolve

38. Before beginning the experiment, the lead researcher carefully _____ the safety protocols that all team members were required to follow.

- (A) disregarded
- (B) enumerated
- (C) obscured
- (D) contradicted

39. The new drainage system was designed to _____ flooding conditions in the low-lying neighborhoods that had suffered repeatedly.

- (A) worsen
- (B) perpetuate
- (C) ameliorate
- (D) exacerbate

40. The second eyewitness account served to _____ the first witness's claim that the suspect had been seen leaving the building at midnight.

- (A) contradict
- (B) undermine
- (C) corroborate
- (D) negate

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41. His _____ reason for the late-night visit was returning a borrowed book, but his real motivation was to check whether his colleague was working late.
- (A) genuine
 - (B) ostensible
 - (C) sincere
 - (D) transparent
42. Social media trends are notoriously _____: a meme that dominates every feed on Monday is forgotten entirely by Friday.
- (A) enduring
 - (B) permanent
 - (C) ephemeral
 - (D) timeless
43. Her _____ was evident when she abandoned the theoretically optimal solution in favor of one that could actually be implemented by Monday.
- (A) idealism
 - (B) pragmatism
 - (C) romanticism
 - (D) dogmatism
44. What had begun as a collegial disagreement devolved into personal _____, with both sides exchanging bitter accusations in the press.
- (A) goodwill
 - (B) camaraderie
 - (C) acrimony
 - (D) warmth
45. The _____ investor lost his savings to a scheme that promised a 40% monthly return — a claim any skeptic would have immediately questioned.
- (A) skeptical
 - (B) cautious
 - (C) credulous
 - (D) discerning
46. Running into her former professor at the conference was entirely _____: neither had planned to attend, yet that chance meeting launched a major collaboration.
- (A) planned
 - (B) deliberate
 - (C) fortuitous
 - (D) contrived

47. True to his _____ reputation, the general's entire battle plan was summarized in three sentences.

- (A) verbose
- (B) laconic
- (C) loquacious
- (D) garrulous

48. Though she possessed genuine expertise, her _____ manner in meetings — rarely volunteering opinions, always deferring to others — masked her true abilities.

- (A) assertive
- (B) diffident
- (C) domineering
- (D) confident

49. The documentary's final scene — a soldier returning home to a daughter who had grown up without him — was deeply _____.

- (A) trivial
- (B) tedious
- (C) poignant
- (D) mundane

50. The _____ salesman barely paused for breath as he transitioned from praising the car's fuel efficiency to its safety ratings to its resale value.

- (A) taciturn
- (B) voluble
- (C) reticent
- (D) morose

Part B — Words in Context

Directions: Read each passage, then answer the questions that follow.

Passage 3 — Two Kinds of Deception

Financial regulators have identified two distinct deceptive strategies. The first is obfuscation: hiding true figures behind layers of jargon, footnotes, and complex accounting structures so that even trained analysts struggle to understand the actual financial position. The second is the use of specious reasoning: arguments that appear logical and well-supported but that, on careful inspection, rest on faulty premises or cherry-picked data. Obfuscation operates through complexity; specious argument operates through apparent plausibility.

WIC-5. As used in the passage, 'obfuscation' involves making information:

- (A) deliberately false
- (B) intentionally unclear through complexity
- (C) temporarily unavailable
- (D) detailed but accurate

WIC-6. The word 'specious' in the passage most nearly means:

- (A) highly technical
- (B) excessively optimistic
- (C) superficially convincing but actually flawed
- (D) based on incomplete data

Passage 4 — The Peace Negotiators

History remembers the negotiators of the 1648 Peace of Westphalia as statesmen of rare ability. Where many leaders had been intransigent — clinging to maximalist demands long after the human cost of the war had become catastrophic — the Westphalian negotiators chose a different path. They were magnanimous in a way that confounded their contemporaries: willing to grant former enemies terms that allowed dignity in defeat, calculating that a stable peace required the losers to feel they had not been humiliated.

WIC-7. As used in the passage, 'intransigent' leaders were those who:

- (A) sought peace at any price
- (B) refused to adjust demands regardless of consequences
- (C) lacked the authority to make concessions
- (D) secretly negotiated separate terms

WIC-8. The 'magnanimous' approach of the Westphalian negotiators is best described as:

- (A) granting excessive reparations to victors
- (B) imposing harsh terms to prevent future aggression
- (C) offering generous terms to enable a stable, dignified peace
- (D) prolonging negotiations to maximize advantage

Part C — Matching

Directions: Write the letter of the matching definition (A–J) next to each word.

1. recalcitrant	____ —	A. Happening by lucky chance; fortunate
2. evanescent	____ —	B. Optimistic, especially in a difficult situation
3. sanguine	____ —	C. Bitterness or ill feeling in speech or manner
4. austere	____ —	D. Brief and concise; using very few words
5. equivocal	____ —	E. Lasting for a very short time; transitory
6. ephemeral	____ —	F. Deliberately ambiguous; open to multiple interpretations
7. acrimony	____ —	G. Soon passing out of sight or existence; quickly fading
8. laconic	____ —	H. Evoking a keen sense of sadness or regret
9. poignant	____ —	I. Obstinate uncooperative toward authority
10. fortuitous	____ —	J. Severe or strict; lacking comfort or luxury

Vocabulary Reference

Study these definitions before attempting the exercises.

Word	Part of Speech	Definition
obfuscate	<i>v.</i>	To make obscure, unclear, or unintelligible; to bewilder or confuse deliberately.
perspicacious	<i>adj.</i>	Having a ready insight into things; keenly perceptive and discerning; shrewd.
circumlocution	<i>n.</i>	The use of many words where fewer would do; indirect and roundabout speech.
propitious	<i>adj.</i>	Giving or indicating a good chance of success; favorable; auspicious.
inveterate	<i>adj.</i>	Having a particular habit, activity, or interest that is long-established and unlikely to change.
perfidious	<i>adj.</i>	Deceitful and untrustworthy; guilty of betrayal; treacherous.
sophistry	<i>n.</i>	The use of clever but false arguments, especially with the intent to deceive.
garrulous	<i>adj.</i>	Excessively talkative, especially on trivial matters; wordy.
truculent	<i>adj.</i>	Eager or quick to argue or fight; aggressively defiant.
mendacious	<i>adj.</i>	Not telling the truth; given to lying; dishonest.
sycophant	<i>n.</i>	A person who acts obsequiously toward someone important in order to gain advantage; a flatterer.
intransigent	<i>adj.</i>	Unwilling or refusing to change one's views or to agree; uncompromising.
magnanimous	<i>adj.</i>	Very generous or forgiving, especially toward a rival or someone less powerful.
veracious	<i>adj.</i>	Speaking or representing the truth; habitually truthful.
penurious	<i>adj.</i>	Extremely poor; poverty-stricken; also, excessively unwilling to spend.
vituperate	<i>v.</i>	To blame or insult someone in strong or violent language; to berate harshly.
inimical	<i>adj.</i>	Tending to obstruct or harm; unfriendly; hostile in effect.

Word	Part of Speech	Definition
specious	<i>adj.</i>	Superficially plausible but actually wrong or misleading.
supercilious	<i>adj.</i>	Behaving or looking as though one thinks one is superior to others; disdainful.
indefatigable	<i>adj.</i>	Persisting tirelessly; incapable of being fatigued; never showing signs of tiring.
querulous	<i>adj.</i>	Complaining in a petulant or whining manner; fretful.
recondite	<i>adj.</i>	Not known by many people; obscure; dealing with abstruse subject matter.
pusillanimous	<i>adj.</i>	Showing a lack of courage or determination; timid; cowardly.
pellucid	<i>adj.</i>	Translucently clear; easily understood; lucid.
impecunious	<i>adj.</i>	Having little or no money; penniless; chronically poor.

Part A — Sentence Completion

Directions: Choose the word (A–D) that best completes the sentence.

51. Critics accused the company of using technical jargon deliberately to _____ the true cost of its subscription plans.

- (A) clarify
- (B) illuminate
- (C) obfuscate
- (D) simplify

52. A _____ observer would have noticed that the witness contradicted herself three times — details that the less experienced attorney overlooked entirely.

- (A) oblivious
- (B) perspicacious
- (C) inattentive
- (D) naive

53. Instead of simply saying the company had lost money, the CFO resorted to _____, spending ten minutes on 'revenue optimization challenges and margin compression events.'

- (A) brevity
- (B) circumlocution
- (C) candor
- (D) precision

54. With inflation falling and consumer confidence rising, the economic climate seemed _____ for launching a new retail venture.

- (A) inauspicious
- (B) ominous
- (C) propitious
- (D) bleak

55. An _____ traveler, she had visited every country in South America and was already planning her second circuit of Southeast Asia.

- (A) occasional
- (B) reluctant
- (C) inveterate
- (D) sporadic

56. The general's _____ aide had been secretly passing troop positions to the enemy for months before being caught.

- (A) loyal
- (B) trustworthy
- (C) perfidious
- (D) faithful

57. His argument sounded persuasive at first, but under examination it was pure _____: the statistics had been cherry-picked to mislead.

- (A) logic
- (B) sophistry
- (C) reasoning
- (D) evidence

58. The _____ neighbor would appear at the door for what she described as 'a quick question' and remain for two hours.

- (A) taciturn
- (B) reserved
- (C) garrulous
- (D) reclusive

59. The coach became _____ when the referee made a controversial call, storming onto the field and shouting until ejected from the game.

- (A) placid
- (B) serene
- (C) truculent
- (D) composed

60. The investigation revealed that the company's press releases had been consistently _____, overstating profits and hiding debt.

- (A) accurate
- (B) mendacious
- (C) candid
- (D) veracious

61. Every time the executive walked into the room, his team of _____ rushed to agree with whatever opinion he expressed, regardless of its merit.

- (A) critics
- (B) sycophants
- (C) adversaries
- (D) skeptics

62. Negotiations collapsed because both sides were _____: neither would give an inch, even on points that clearly required compromise.

- (A) flexible
- (B) accommodating
- (C) intransigent
- (D) conciliatory

63. After winning the championship, the coach was _____ in victory, praising the opposing team's performance and refusing to gloat.

- (A) petty
- (B) vindictive
- (C) magnanimous
- (D) churlish

64. History has vindicated her as a _____ journalist: every claim in her controversial report has since been independently verified.

- (A) mendacious
- (B) deceptive
- (C) veracious
- (D) dishonest

65. Despite his family's _____ circumstances, he refused charity, instead working three jobs to put himself through college.

- (A) affluent
- (B) prosperous
- (C) penurious
- (D) comfortable

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66. The columnist _____ the administration for what he called its systematic dismantling of environmental protections, using language rarely seen in a mainstream newspaper.
- (A) praised
 - (B) vituperated
 - (C) commended
 - (D) lauded
67. Chronic sleep deprivation is _____ to cognitive performance; students who consistently sleep fewer than six hours score measurably lower on memory tests.
- (A) beneficial
 - (B) conducive
 - (C) inimical
 - (D) favorable
68. The lobbyist's _____ argument that pollution controls would destroy jobs sounded reasonable, but studies consistently showed the opposite effect.
- (A) rigorous
 - (B) specious
 - (C) cogent
 - (D) irrefutable
69. The sommelier's _____ sneer at the customer's choice of house wine made the entire table deeply uncomfortable.
- (A) humble
 - (B) supercilious
 - (C) deferential
 - (D) gracious
70. An _____ advocate for prison reform, she delivered over three hundred speeches across twenty states in a single year without slowing her pace.
- (A) sluggish
 - (B) indolent
 - (C) indefatigable
 - (D) lethargic
71. The _____ patient complained about the room temperature, the food, the noise, and finally the shape of the pillow, exhausting even the most patient nurses.
- (A) stoic
 - (B) querulous
 - (C) serene
 - (D) resigned

72. His dissertation explored the _____ connections between medieval Flemish tax law and double-entry bookkeeping — a topic few outside his field had heard of.

- (A) well-known
- (B) recondite
- (C) mainstream
- (D) familiar

73. His _____ response to the bullying — walking away without a word and never reporting it — only encouraged further mistreatment.

- (A) courageous
- (B) pusillanimous
- (C) valiant
- (D) audacious

74. The legal brief was unusually _____ for such a complex case; even lay readers could follow the reasoning without legal training.

- (A) convoluted
- (B) opaque
- (C) pellucid
- (D) abstruse

75. The _____ graduate student subsisted on instant noodles and library coffee while completing her dissertation, unable to afford even basic luxuries.

- (A) affluent
- (B) wealthy
- (C) impecunious
- (D) prosperous

Part B — Words in Context

Directions: Read each passage, then answer the questions that follow.

Passage 5 — The Fading Mural

The muralist had spent three years on the work, and yet she described her creation as intentionally evanescent. Applied directly to a crumbling exterior wall, the colors would fade and peel within a decade. She saw no contradiction between the labor of creation and the certainty of decay; for her, the ephemeral nature of the work was its central statement — that beauty, precisely because it cannot last, demands our full attention while it remains.

WIC-9. The word 'evanescent' as used in the passage most nearly means:

- (A) brilliantly colored
- (B) gradually fading into nothing
- (C) deeply symbolic
- (D) structurally fragile

WIC-10. In context, 'ephemeral' primarily describes:

- (A) the artist's technique
- (B) the audience's reaction
- (C) the brief duration of the mural's existence
- (D) the fragile materials used

Passage 6 — The Diagnostician

Dr. Vasquez had a reputation in the hospital that bordered on legend. Where other physicians worked through standard checklists, she noticed the details others missed: an asymmetric pupil dilating a fraction too slowly, a patient's posture suggesting guarded abdominal pain rather than musculoskeletal discomfort. Her perspicacious diagnoses had saved lives precisely because she refused to accept the obvious explanation when a subtler truth was available. She was also unusually lucid in her explanations, ensuring patients understood not just their diagnosis but the reasoning behind it.

WIC-11. As used in the passage, 'perspicacious' most nearly means:

- (A) methodically thorough
- (B) highly experienced
- (C) keenly perceptive and insightful
- (D) unusually cautious

WIC-12. The word 'lucid' as used in the passage primarily means:

- (A) technically precise
- (B) empathetic and kind
- (C) clear and easy to understand
- (D) unusually brief

Passage 7 — The Defense Attorney

Public defenders learn early that circumlocution is a luxury they cannot afford. Jurors who follow a rambling argument lose the thread; a judge who must parse obscure phrasing grows impatient. The most effective public defenders speak with the pellucid directness of someone who has stripped every unnecessary word from their argument, leaving only what is essential. The sentence that cannot be misunderstood is the sentence most likely to be believed.

WIC-13. As used in the passage, 'circumlocution' is presented as:

- (A) a persuasive rhetorical device
- (B) an inefficient, roundabout way of speaking
- (C) a sign of legal expertise
- (D) a technique for managing difficult jurors

WIC-14. The word 'pellucid' as used here most nearly means:

- (A) aggressive and forceful
- (B) emotionally compelling
- (C) crystal clear and easily understood
- (D) formally structured

Part C — Matching

Directions: Write the letter of the matching definition (A–J) next to each word.

1. obfuscate	_____	A. Translucently clear; easily understood
2. perspicacious	_____	B. The use of many words where fewer would do
3. circumlocution	_____	C. Clever but false argument designed to deceive
4. inveterate	_____	D. Superficially plausible but actually wrong or misleading
5. sophistry	_____	E. Having a firmly established, long-standing habit
6. mendacious	_____	F. Keenly perceptive and discerning; shrewd
7. magnanimous	_____	G. Persisting tirelessly; never showing signs of fatigue
8. specious	_____	H. Not telling the truth; habitually dishonest
9. indefatigable	_____	I. Very generous or forgiving toward a rival

10. pellucid		J. To make obscure or unintelligible deliberately
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Vocabulary Reference

Study these definitions before attempting the exercises.

Word	Part of Speech	Definition
insouciance	<i>n.</i>	Casual lack of concern; indifference; a relaxed and unconcerned manner.
desiccate	<i>v.</i>	To remove moisture from; to dry out thoroughly; to preserve by drying.
obdurate	<i>adj.</i>	Stubbornly refusing to change one's opinion or course of action; hardened.
sesquipedalian	<i>adj.</i>	Given to using long words; (of a word) long and ponderous.
logomachy	<i>n.</i>	An argument about words; a dispute in which words rather than ideas are at issue.
solipsism	<i>n.</i>	The philosophical view that the self is all that can be known to exist.
tendentious	<i>adj.</i>	Promoting a particular cause or point of view; not impartial; biased.
internecine	<i>adj.</i>	Destructive to both sides in a conflict; relating to conflict within a group.
pleonasm	<i>n.</i>	The use of more words than are necessary for clear expression; redundancy in wording.
contumacious	<i>adj.</i>	Stubbornly or willfully disobedient to authority; rebelliously resistant.
nugatory	<i>adj.</i>	Of no value or importance; useless; having no legal force.
sempiternal	<i>adj.</i>	Eternal and unchanging; everlasting; existing through all time.
lucubration	<i>n.</i>	Laborious study or meditation, especially at night; a piece of writing produced by such study.
lassitude	<i>n.</i>	Physical or mental weariness; lack of energy; a state of fatigue and languor.
minatory	<i>adj.</i>	Expressing or conveying a threat; menacing; of a threatening nature.
apothegm	<i>n.</i>	A short, witty, instructive saying; a concise formulation of a truth or principle.
effulgent	<i>adj.</i>	Radiant; shining brilliantly; resplendently bright.
parlous	<i>adj.</i>	Full of danger or uncertainty; perilous; attended with risk.

Word	Part of Speech	Definition
compunction	<i>n.</i>	A feeling of guilt or moral scruple that prevents or follows wrongdoing.
tenebrous	<i>adj.</i>	Dark and gloomy; shadowy; obscure.
crepuscular	<i>adj.</i>	Of, resembling, or relating to twilight; (of animals) appearing or active at dawn or dusk.
pugnacious	<i>adj.</i>	Eager or quick to argue, quarrel, or fight; combative by disposition.
sagacious	<i>adj.</i>	Having or showing keen mental discernment and good judgment; wise.
vociferous	<i>adj.</i>	Expressing or characterized by vehement opinions; loud and forceful.
ineffable	<i>adj.</i>	Too great or extreme to be expressed or described in words; inexpressible.

Part A — Sentence Completion

Directions: Choose the word (A–D) that best completes the sentence.

76. He accepted the news of his demotion with an _____ that unnerved his supervisor, shrugging and asking what time lunch was served.

- (A) anguish
- (B) insouciance
- (C) consternation
- (D) distress

77. Left in the kiln too long, the clay figurines began to _____ and crack along hairline fractures.

- (A) moisten
- (B) saturate
- (C) desiccate
- (D) hydrate

78. Despite overwhelming evidence to the contrary, the scientist remained _____ in her original hypothesis, refusing to revise her model.

- (A) flexible
- (B) obdurate
- (C) open-minded
- (D) receptive

-
- 79.** The professor's _____ lecture style — peppered with words like 'heterophenomenology' and 'transubstantiation' — alienated undergraduates.
- (A) simple
 - (B) sesquipedalian
 - (C) accessible
 - (D) elementary
- 80.** The two philosophers spent an entire symposium in _____, debating whether 'knowledge' required 'certainty' without agreeing on what either word meant.
- (A) consensus
 - (B) logomachy
 - (C) collaboration
 - (D) harmony
- 81.** His critics accused him of _____, arguing that he wrote exclusively from his own perspective and seemed incapable of imagining any other existence.
- (A) altruism
 - (B) solipsism
 - (C) empathy
 - (D) generosity
- 82.** The documentary was widely criticized as _____ because it presented only evidence supporting one side and omitted contradictory findings entirely.
- (A) balanced
 - (B) tendentious
 - (C) objective
 - (D) impartial
- 83.** The _____ struggle between the party's two factions damaged both wings so severely that the opposition won a landslide victory.
- (A) cooperative
 - (B) internecine
 - (C) productive
 - (D) beneficial
- 84.** 'Free gift' is a classic example of _____: since gifts are by definition free, the word 'free' is entirely redundant.
- (A) precision
 - (B) pleonasm
 - (C) economy
 - (D) ambiguity

85. The _____ prisoner refused to stand when the judge entered, ignored three direct orders from bailiffs, and had to be physically restrained.

- (A) deferential
- (B) obedient
- (C) contumacious
- (D) compliant

86. The amendment was _____: it had been so heavily revised to win votes that it no longer addressed the problem it was designed to solve.

- (A) vital
- (B) nugatory
- (C) consequential
- (D) significant

87. The philosopher argued that mathematical truths are _____: they do not exist in time and cannot be changed by physical events.

- (A) transient
- (B) sempiternal
- (C) ephemeral
- (D) fleeting

88. The final chapter bore the marks of years of _____: every paragraph was dense with cross-references, footnotes, and labored argumentation.

- (A) improvisation
- (B) lucubration
- (C) negligence
- (D) carelessness

89. A profound _____ overcame the team after months of seventy-hour weeks; even the most dedicated members struggled to concentrate.

- (A) energy
- (B) vigor
- (C) lassitude
- (D) exhilaration

90. The landlord's _____ letter warned tenants that any further noise complaints would result in immediate eviction proceedings.

- (A) reassuring
- (B) minatory
- (C) welcoming
- (D) encouraging

91. 'Do not multiply entities beyond necessity' — known as Occam's Razor — is perhaps the most influential _____ in the history of science.

- (A) contradiction
- (B) apothegm
- (C) fallacy
- (D) paradox

92. The cathedral's rose window was _____ in the afternoon light, casting pools of crimson and gold across the stone floor.

- (A) dim
- (B) effulgent
- (C) shadowy
- (D) murky

93. The expedition's _____ state became clear when the team's last radio broke, supplies ran low, and a storm system closed in from the north.

- (A) stable
- (B) parlous
- (C) secure
- (D) manageable

94. She felt no _____ about resigning without notice after discovering the company had deliberately misled investors for years.

- (A) compunction
- (B) pride
- (C) satisfaction
- (D) indifference

95. The explorers descended into a _____ cavern where no sunlight had penetrated in centuries, their torches barely holding back the absolute dark.

- (A) luminous
- (B) tenebrous
- (C) radiant
- (D) brilliant

96. Deer are _____ animals, most active at dawn and dusk when the light is low enough to conceal them yet bright enough to spot predators.

- (A) nocturnal
- (B) diurnal
- (C) crepuscular
- (D) hibernating

97. The _____ columnist welcomed every reader complaint as an opportunity for another argument, responding to each letter with increased ferocity.

- (A) peaceful
- (B) pugnacious
- (C) amicable
- (D) placid

98. The _____ investor had anticipated the market correction six months before it happened, quietly repositioning her portfolio while others dismissed the warning signs.

- (A) naive
- (B) reckless
- (C) sagacious
- (D) impulsive

99. The _____ protesters outside the courthouse made it impossible to conduct the press conference, drowning out every speaker with chants and horn blasts.

- (A) silent
- (B) vociferous
- (C) subdued
- (D) quiet

100. Survivors of the disaster struggled to describe what they had witnessed; some called the experience _____, beyond the reach of language.

- (A) describable
- (B) ineffable
- (C) ordinary
- (D) mundane

Part B — Words in Context

Directions: Read each passage, then answer the questions that follow.

Passage 8 — The Indefatigable Activist

Maya Chen had been fighting for clean water access in rural communities for over two decades. What struck observers most was not the scale of her victories — though these were considerable — but her indefatigable commitment across stretches of failure and setback. During years when legislation stalled and funding dried up, she continued organizing, speaking, and filing suits. The lassitude that eventually overtook her colleagues seemed constitutionally impossible for her; she appeared to draw energy from the obstacles themselves.

WIC-15. As used in the passage, 'indefatigable' most nearly means:

- (A) unusually optimistic
- (B) persistently tireless despite setbacks
- (C) strategically patient
- (D) emotionally resilient

WIC-16. The word 'lassitude' as used in the passage refers to:

- (A) a loss of strategic direction
- (B) physical illness
- (C) deep fatigue and lack of energy
- (D) growing cynicism about outcomes

Passage 9 — The Concert

The musician struggled afterward to explain what had happened on stage that night. The usual words — 'transcendent,' 'moving,' 'unforgettable' — felt inadequate, even insulting. What she had experienced was ineffable, she finally said; the harder she reached for language, the more the experience retreated from description. The audience, it turned out, felt the same way. Reviews the next morning were vociferous in their praise but oddly imprecise, as though every critic had agreed that this was extraordinary without being able to say exactly why.

WIC-17. As used in the passage, 'ineffable' most nearly means:

- (A) deeply personal and private
- (B) too intense to remember clearly
- (C) impossible to forget
- (D) beyond the ability of language to capture

WIC-18. The word 'vociferous' as used in the passage most nearly means:

- (A) uniform and collective
- (B) loud and forcefully expressed
- (C) carefully considered
- (D) unexpectedly enthusiastic

Passage 10 — The Partisan Documentary

The film had been marketed as an objective account of the city council's controversial rezoning decision, but viewers quickly recognized it as tendentious. Every interview subject was a critic of the plan; every piece of footage emphasized disorder and opposition. The director's sagacious choice of music — dissonant strings under scenes of construction, warm strings under community gatherings — guided the viewer's emotional response without a single word of editorial commentary. The message was unmistakable even while remaining technically unspoken.

WIC-19. As used in the passage, 'tendentious' most nearly means:

- (A) poorly researched
- (B) emotionally manipulative
- (C) biased toward a particular viewpoint
- (D) factually inaccurate

WIC-20. The word 'sagacious' as used in the passage primarily means:

- (A) controversial and risky
- (B) technically accomplished
- (C) showing keen discernment and strategic intelligence
- (D) deliberately deceptive

Part C — Matching

Directions: Write the letter of the matching definition (A–J) next to each word.

1. insouciance	____ —	A. Too great or extreme to be expressed in words
2. obdurate	____ —	B. Eternal and unchanging; everlasting
3. tendentious	____ —	C. Casual lack of concern; indifference
4. internecine	____ —	D. Physical or mental weariness; lack of energy
5. nugatory	____ —	E. Stubbornly refusing to change opinion or course
6. sempiternal	____ —	F. Promoting a particular point of view; biased
7. lassitude	____ —	G. Having keen mental discernment and good judgment
8. minatory	____ —	H. Destructive to both sides in a conflict

9. sagacious	_____	I. Of no value or importance; useless
10. ineffable	_____	J. Expressing or conveying a threat; menacing

Answer Key

Full explanations are provided for all Sentence Completion and Words in Context questions. Review each explanation carefully — understanding why an answer is correct is as important as knowing the answer itself.

Section 1 — Tier 1 — Foundation

Part A — Sentence Completion

Q1. Answer: B

'Pragmatic' (sensible, realistic) contrasts with 'idealistic' — the key signal word in the sentence.

Q3. Answer: C

'Concise' means giving much information in few words, which matches the one-page constraint stated.

Q5. Answer: C

'Prodigal' means wastefully extravagant; spending an entire fortune in two years fits perfectly.

Q7. Answer: B

Publicly admitting being wrong is candid — truthful and straightforward, especially when it is difficult to be so.

Q9. Answer: B

Completing all assignments and study sessions consistently describes diligence — careful and conscientious effort.

Q11. Answer: B

Working for completely different use cases shows the software adapts to many functions — the definition of versatile.

Q13. Answer: D

A description so detailed it places readers inside the scene is vivid — producing powerful and clear mental images.

Q15. Answer: C

Making a difficult concept accessible to non-specialists describes a lucid explanation — clear and easy to understand.

Q17. Answer: C

Reducing but not eliminating damage describes mitigation — making something less severe.

Q19. Answer: C

Q2. Answer: C

When opposing parties can read contradictory meanings into the same text, the language is ambiguous — open to more than one interpretation.

Q4. Answer: B

Examining every document for the smallest discrepancy exemplifies meticulousness — great attention to detail.

Q6. Answer: B

Moving jurors and earning the judge's praise for clarity describes eloquence — fluent, persuasive, emotionally resonant speech.

Q8. Answer: C

Giving anonymously to benefit children is benevolent — well meaning and generous.

Q10. Answer: C

Routine emails following high-stakes work would feel dull and ordinary — mundane.

Q12. Answer: B

Revising and resubmitting after repeated rejection shows tenacity — persistent, firm adherence to a purpose.

Q14. Answer: C

Refusing to accept the press release at face value and demanding evidence describes skepticism.

Q16. Answer: B

Redirecting attention away from the secret action is to divert — to cause a change of course or to distract.

Q18. Answer: B

Examining every weld joint is to scrutinize — to inspect closely and thoroughly.

Q20. Answer: C

Intensifying and improving flavors is to enhance — to increase quality or value.

Q21. Answer: C

Showing historical scenes in a mural is to depict — to represent or portray.

Q23. Answer: C

Offering specific improvement suggestions after analysis is to critique — to evaluate in a detailed and analytical way.

Q25. Answer: B

A troubling difference in rates between two groups is a disparity — a great difference or inequality.

Combining three offices into one is consolidation — making stronger by combining into one.

Q22. Answer: B

Using public platforms to support a cause is to advocate — to publicly recommend or champion.

Q24. Answer: B

Trying hard to achieve a goal despite obstacles is to endeavor.

Part B — Words in Context

WIC-1. Answer: B

'Concise' here means brief and information-dense (bullet points, no wasted words), not incomplete or simplified.

WIC-2. Answer: C

Eloquence here is shown by her ability to leave listeners in stunned silence — grace and persuasive power.

WIC-3. Answer: B

Dr. Okafor believes the results point toward a breakthrough — a confident, optimistic reading.

WIC-4. Answer: C

The passage explicitly calls their disagreement the 'engine' of progress — skepticism is a necessary check.

Part C — Matching

pragmatic: F	ambiguous: I	meticulous: G	prodigal: C	eloquent: B
candid: E	diligent: H	tenacious: J	skeptical: D	lucid: A

Section 2 — Tier 2 — Intermediate

Part A — Sentence Completion

Q26. Answer: C

Refusing to comply despite repeated warnings from authority describes recalcitrance — obstinately uncooperative.

Q28. Answer: B

Burning off within hours and leaving no trace is evanescence — soon passing out of existence.

Q30. Answer: C

Obsessively correcting grammar in casual settings is pedantic — excessively concerned with minor rules.

Q32. Answer: C

Speaking continuously for hours without pausing is loquacious — tending to talk a great deal.

Q27. Answer: C

Professionals from completely different fields are disparate — essentially different in kind, not easily compared.

Q29. Answer: C

Remaining optimistic about long-term prospects despite bad early numbers is to be sanguine.

Q31. Answer: C

A statement that could mean almost anything is equivocal — deliberately open to multiple interpretations.

Q33. Answer: C

A bare room with minimal possessions describes austerity — severe, lacking comforts or luxuries.

Q34. Answer: B

Seeking someone's counsel because of deep respect is to venerate — to regard with great respect and reverence.

Q36. Answer: B

Making an already critical shortage worse is to exacerbate — to make a bad situation worse.

Q38. Answer: B

Carefully listing safety protocols one by one is to enumerate them.

Q40. Answer: C

A second account that confirms the first is corroborating evidence.

Q42. Answer: C

A trend forgotten in days is ephemeral — lasting for a very short time.

Q44. Answer: C

Personal bitterness and hostile accusations describe acrimony — ill feeling and bitterness in speech or manner.

Q46. Answer: C

A lucky, unplanned meeting that leads to something positive is fortuitous — happening by lucky chance.

Q48. Answer: B

Rarely volunteering opinions and deferring to others from lack of self-confidence is diffident behavior.

Q50. Answer: B

Talking incessantly and fluently without pause is voluble behavior — talkative and flowing.

Q35. Answer: C

Offering something to reduce hostility is to placate — to make someone less angry or hostile.

Q37. Answer: C

Causing a crisis to happen suddenly and prematurely is to precipitate it.

Q39. Answer: C

Designing a system to improve flooding conditions is to ameliorate — to make something bad better.

Q41. Answer: B

The stated reason that may not reflect the true reason is the ostensible reason — appearing to be true but not necessarily so.

Q43. Answer: B

Choosing what is workable over what is theoretically optimal reflects pragmatism — valuing practical application.

Q45. Answer: C

Believing a clearly implausible promise without question is credulous — too ready to believe things.

Q47. Answer: B

Summarizing a battle plan in three sentences reflects laconicism — using very few words.

Q49. Answer: C

A scene that evokes a keen sense of sadness and emotional resonance is poignant.

Part B — Words in Context**WIC-5. Answer: B**

Obfuscation is defined in the passage as hiding figures behind jargon and complexity — intentionally unclear.

WIC-6. Answer: C

The passage describes specious reasoning as appearing logical but resting on faulty premises — superficially convincing but actually wrong.

WIC-7. Answer: B

Intransigent leaders clung to maximalist demands even as the human cost became catastrophic — refusing to change position.

WIC-8. Answer: C

Magnanimous means generously granting terms that gave losers dignity, calculated to produce lasting stability.

Part C — Matching

recalcitrant: I	evanescent: G	sanguine: B	austere: J	equivocal: F
ephemeral: E	acrimony: C	laconic: D	poignant: H	fortuitous: A

Section 3 — Tier 3 — Advanced

Part A — Sentence Completion

Q51. Answer: C

Using jargon deliberately to hide the true cost is to obfuscate — to make obscure or unintelligible.

Q53. Answer: B

Using many words where 'the company lost money' would suffice is circumlocution — indirect and verbose expression.

Q55. Answer: C

A deeply rooted, long-established habit of traveling describes an inveterate traveler.

Q57. Answer: B

A clever-sounding argument that is actually misleading is sophistry — false argument designed to deceive.

Q59. Answer: C

Aggressively arguing and getting ejected describes truculence — eager and quick to fight or argue.

Q61. Answer: B

People who agree with everything their superior says to gain favor are sycophants — obsequious flatterers.

Q63. Answer: C

Praising opponents in victory rather than gloating is magnanimous — very generous or forgiving toward a rival.

Q65. Answer: C

Working three jobs because charity is the only alternative suggests extreme poverty — penurious circumstances.

Q67. Answer: C

Something that harms or obstructs a process is inimical to it — tending to obstruct or harm.

Q69. Answer: B

Sneering at someone's choice as if one is superior is supercilious behavior — disdainful and condescending.

Q71. Answer: B

Constant complaining about every small thing is querulous behavior — petulant and whining.

Q52. Answer: B

Noticing subtle contradictions others miss describes perspicacity — keenly perceptive and discerning.

Q54. Answer: C

A favorable economic climate that gives a good chance of success is propitious.

Q56. Answer: C

Secretly betraying one's commander to the enemy is perfidious — deceitful and guilty of betrayal.

Q58. Answer: C

Talking excessively about trivial matters is garrulous behavior.

Q60. Answer: B

Overstating profits and hiding debt in press releases is mendacious — not telling the truth; dishonest.

Q62. Answer: C

Refusing to change positions or compromise is intransigence — unwilling to agree.

Q64. Answer: C

Someone whose every claim is verified is veracious — habitually truthful.

Q66. Answer: B

Attacking with strong and violent language is to vituperate — to blame or insult using harsh speech.

Q68. Answer: B

An argument that sounds plausible but is actually wrong or misleading is specious.

Q70. Answer: C

Delivering hundreds of speeches without slowing describes indefatigable effort — persisting tirelessly.

Q72. Answer: B

A topic not known by many people — connections between obscure medieval subjects — is recondite.

Q73. Answer: B

Avoiding confrontation out of timidity is pusillanimous — showing a lack of courage or determination.

Q74. Answer: C

Writing so clear that non-experts can follow it is pellucid — translucently clear; easily understood.

Q75. Answer: C

Unable to afford basic luxuries is impecunious — having little or no money.

Part B — Words in Context**WIC-9. Answer: B**

The mural is described as fading and peeling over time — a gradual vanishing, which is evanescence.

WIC-10. Answer: C

The ephemeral nature refers to the mural not lasting — its brief existence is the work's central statement.

WIC-11. Answer: C

Noticing subtle details others miss and refusing to accept obvious explanations describes perspicacity — keen perception.

WIC-12. Answer: C

Ensuring patients understood both diagnosis and reasoning describes lucid communication — clear and easy to understand.

WIC-13. Answer: B

The passage contrasts circumlocution with the direct, stripped-down speech effective defenders use — it is inefficient and roundabout.

WIC-14. Answer: C

Pellucid directness — stripping every unnecessary word and leaving only the essential — means crystal clear.

Part C — Matching

obfuscate: J	perspicacious: F	circumlocution: B	inveterate: E	sophistry: C
mendacious: H	magnanimous: I	specious: D	indefatigable: G	pellucid: A

Section 4 — Tier 4 — Expert**Part A — Sentence Completion****Q76. Answer: B**

Responding to serious news with a shrug and asking about lunch is the very image of insouciance — casual indifference.

Q77. Answer: C

Drying out and cracking in a kiln is to desiccate — to remove moisture; to dry out thoroughly.

Q78. Answer: B

Refusing to change one's position despite overwhelming contrary evidence is obdurate stubbornness.

Q79. Answer: B

Using very long, complex words in a lecture is sesquipedalian — given to using long words.

Q80. Answer: B

An argument revolving entirely around the meaning of words rather than underlying concepts is logomachy.

Q81. Answer: B

Being incapable of imagining any reality beyond one's own reflects solipsism — the view that only the self can be known.

Q82. Answer: B**Q83. Answer: B**

Presenting only one side while omitting contradictory evidence is tendentious — biased toward a particular viewpoint.

Q84. Answer: B

Using more words than necessary when one word would suffice is pleonasm — redundancy in wording.

Q86. Answer: B

Something revised into uselessness is nugatory — of no value or importance.

Q88. Answer: B

Dense paragraphs full of cross-references produced over years of laborious study are the product of lucubration.

Q90. Answer: B

A letter warning of immediate eviction is minatory — expressing or conveying a threat.

Q92. Answer: B

A window shining brilliantly and casting pools of light is effulgent — radiant; shining brightly.

Q94. Answer: A

Feeling no guilt or moral scruple about an action is feeling no compunction. Note the negative phrasing here.

Q96. Answer: C

Active at dawn and dusk — the twilight hours — is the precise definition of crepuscular.

Q98. Answer: C

Anticipating problems others miss through keen judgment is sagacious — having keen mental discernment and good judgment.

Q100. Answer: B

An experience beyond the reach of language is ineffable — too great or extreme to be expressed in words.

A conflict that damages both sides — both party factions harming each other — is internecine.

Q85. Answer: C

Stubbornly disobeying multiple direct orders from authority figures is contumacious behavior.

Q87. Answer: B

Mathematical truths that are eternal and unchanging are sempiternal — everlasting and unchangeable.

Q89. Answer: C

Mental and physical weariness after sustained overwork is lassitude — lack of energy.

Q91. Answer: B

A short, witty, instructive saying with lasting influence is an apothegm.

Q93. Answer: B

Running out of supplies and communication while a storm closes in is a parlous state — full of danger.

Q95. Answer: B

A cavern of absolute darkness where sunlight never reaches is tenebrous — dark and gloomy.

Q97. Answer: B

Welcoming every complaint as a chance for argument with increasing ferocity is pugnacious — combative by disposition.

Q99. Answer: B

Protesters drowning out speakers with loud, forceful chanting are vociferous — loudly and vehemently expressive.

Part B — Words in Context

WIC-15. Answer: B

Continuing across years of failure without slowing is indefatigable — persisting tirelessly.

WIC-16. Answer: C

The lassitude that overtook colleagues is contrasted with Chen's energy — it is deep fatigue and lack of energy.

WIC-17. Answer: D

The harder she reached for language the more it retreated — the experience was ineffable, beyond language.

WIC-18. Answer: B

Vociferous praise from critics means loud and forcefully expressed admiration.

WIC-19. Answer: C

Every choice in the film promotes one side of the debate — the film is tendentious: biased toward a particular cause.

WIC-20. Answer: C

Choosing music to guide emotional response without a word of commentary shows sagacious — keenly discerning — craft.

Part C — Matching

insouciance: C	obdurate: E	tendentious: F	internecine: H	nugatory: I
sempiternal: B	lassitude: D	minatory: J	sagacious: G	ineffable: A

Keep reviewing words you missed. Spaced repetition — revisiting difficult words after 1 day, 3 days, and 1 week — is the most effective method for long-term vocabulary retention.